zila meeting on Zoom app, sometimes mahanagar meeting, sometimes IT heads' meetings, sometimes Yuva Morcha meeting, sometimes a meeting of the Mahila Morcha.' He claimed emphatically that, by July 2020, the BJP had conducted 45 lakh such meetings.

There is no way to independently verify this claim, but the sheer scale of the BJP's shift to Zoom was undeniable. This shift was clearly visible on social-media platforms from April 2020 onwards. Typically, each meeting was followed by party officials taking screenshots and posting pictures of them on social media handles for further publicity (see Figures 8.6 and 8.7).

Figure 8.7: A BJP Virtual Meeting in UP's Deoband, Voting Booth Numbers 387 and 388, July 2020